development of the private sector—augmenting and governing the market, not replacing it.[7]

Technically speaking, shifting of economic policy of a country from one to the other above-given three 'alternative development strategies' is economic reform. But in the history of the world economy, it was inclination of the economies towards the market economy, which have been referred as economic reforms. In the Indian case, economic reform has been used always in this sense. Here, one should note that when India started the programme of economic reforms in the early 1990s, the world view was in favour of privatisation, liberalisation, de-nationalisation, etc. as the main plank of economic reforms. But by the mid-1990s, not only the world view has polarised in favour of the 'mixed economy' but one another change was about to sweep the world economies i.e. the favour for globalisation sponsored by the World Trade Organisation (WTO). Now, the developing economies (mixed economies with planning as their development strategy) as well as the transition economies (Russia and the whole Eastern Europe, China)—who were already promoting the market-oriented reform process were faced with a dilemma. To prosper and compete in the globalising environment while they needed immediate liberation from their state-dominated mode of economies at one hand they also needed to strike a balance between the state and the market on the other. Each one of them tried to strike the balance in their own way with mixed results. In India, the Governments have not been able to convince the masses that the economy needs reforms and the attempted reforms will benefit all. In every election since the reforms of 1991, the voters have not supported a pro-reform government. Though the process of economic reforms started in India with the slogan ***'reforms with human face'***—the slogan has utterly failed to garner the empathy of masses. We may hope that in coming times the masses will start connecting to reforms and are able to get the message clear i.e. reforms are to benefit all.

ECONOMIC REFORMS IN INDIA